

BHOPAL | Home Truth



K.S. SUDARSHAN

After its headquarters in Nagpur and office in Delhi, the RSS' next address of significance is 'Samidha'. A quiet retreat in the upscale Arera Colony in Bhopal, the house will now serve as home to one of the RSS' foremost figures. Former RSS Sarsanghchalak K.S. Sudarshan has decided to shift out of his spiritual home in Nagpur and make Bhopal his post-retirement base after demitting office earlier this year to let Mohan Rao Bhagwat take over. While there has been no official word on what exactly Sudharshan will do in Bhopal, the state police are busy making security arrangements for him as he enjoys Z-plus security. With the RSS displaying increasing assertiveness in Madhya Pradesh BJP affairs, Sudarshan's perennial presence could mean additional scrutiny of Shivraj Singh Chouhan's government.

by Ambresh Mishra

HYDERABAD | Earth Shastra

Google Earth's country cousin is here. Bhuvan, Indian Space Research Organisation's (ISRO) latest launch, offers images of the earth taken from seven of its remote sensing satellites. It can capture images of objects as small as a Nano on the road to build a three-dimensional map of the world. Launched on August 12, Bhuvan promises to do a lot more than G-Earth for India-specific users. It offers better street-by-street coverage and a load of useful metadata ranging across climate, demographics and historical values. But the programme has several teething problems. The site does not load most of the times and is visible only in Internet Explorer 6 or above. ISRO chief G. Madhavan Nair allays fears, however. "With Bhuvan, we will be able to produce local information, which will be useful in addressing local problems like floods, famines and much more," he says.

by Amarnath K. Menon

ISRO'S BHUVAN OFFERS MORE INDIA-SPECIFIC INFORMATION BUT IS HAVING STARTING TROUBLE.

HYDERABAD |

Post Script

Ask any student who designed the Indian flag and very, very few would name

REDDY AT THE STAMP RELEASE



A PRABHAKAR RAO

Pingali Venkaiah. The Andhra freedom fighter who designed the flag that became the inspiration for the Indian tricolour is largely lost in the mists of history. But on August 12 this year, Chief Minister YSR Reddy released a Rs 5-stamp on Venkaiah's 132nd birth anniversary.

by Amarnath K. Menon

JAIPUR | Bright and Early

In a drive to beat the recession, the Rajasthan Tourism Development Corporation (RTDC) has advanced the running schedule of its luxurious train, the Palace on Wheels, by two months. The train, which generally starts its annual run in October, will now be on the tracks from August and already has 370 bookings. The idea, says Manjit Singh, CMD of the corporation, is "to squeeze out whatever we can from wherever is the potential". The fully renovated train has a new itinerary that lets travellers spend longer time at legendary venues like Amber Fort, Ranthambore National Park and Jaisalmer's sand dunes.

by Rohit Parihar



SHEKHAR GHOSH